

Thomas Paavo Hamata

Certified Information Systems Auditor · Founder, Accelerate Advisory (Pty) Ltd · President, ISACA Windhoek Chapter
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ROLE FOR CHECKPOINT

Independent auditor of Checkpoint's technology and privacy controls. Through Accelerate Advisory (Pty) Ltd, Thomas reviews whether the controls that protect guest information work in practice: access management, encryption, the audit trail, retention and deletion, support access by consent, and readiness for the Data Protection Bill. His reports give pilot properties, the Namibia Tourism Board and the Development Bank of Namibia an independent view, separate from the founders.

PROFILE

Audit leader and technology risk professional helping organisations across Africa strengthen digital trust, assurance and regulatory readiness. Experience spans audit leadership, information technology risk and controls, fintech regulation and technology assurance, with assignments across sub-Saharan Africa, the United Kingdom, Canada and the Netherlands. Audit committee member and published voice on technology governance in Namibian business media.

EXPERIENCE

- Technology and operations audit leadership at Standard Bank Namibia, spanning information technology audit, cybersecurity, technology risk, resilience and third-party risk.
- Senior internal audit in the FirstRand Namibia banking group: risk-based audit planning, audit delivery, and executive and governance reporting.
- In-house information technology risk and control at Just Eat Takeaway.com: control design, testing, remediation and third-party assurance in large-scale technology environments.
- Payments Association of Namibia: payments regulation, fintech assessment, payment-stream governance and regulatory compliance.
- Independent information technology audits, advisory engagements and professional training through Accelerate Advisory (Pty) Ltd.

CREDENTIALS AND EDUCATION

- Certified Information Systems Auditor; Control Objectives for Information and Related Technologies (COBIT) 2019 Foundation.
- Accredited ISACA Global Trainer and APMG Accredited Trainer for both qualifications.
- Founder and Lead Facilitator, Accelerate GRC Academy (governance, risk and compliance).
- Financial Sciences, University of Pretoria; Oxford Executive Strategy Programme, Saïd Business School, University of Oxford (focused on building digital trust capability in Namibia); Digital Transformation Strategy for Business Leaders, Gordon Institute of Business Science; Compliance Management, University of Cape Town.